



10 ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

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Kissimmee

2040 Comprehensive Plan

Economic Development

prepared for

City of Kissimmee

prepared by

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date

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Cover photo source: Paul Bowen

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GOALS, OBJECTIVES, AND POLICIES

This section stipulates goals, objectives, and implementing policies for this optional local government comprehensive plan element, pursuant to §163.3177(7)(j), Florida Statutes.

GOAL 10.1: IMPLEMENT ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT RESOURCES.

Develop strategies to implement economic development activities within the City.

OBJECTIVE 10.1.1: ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT DIVISION.

Maintain the City's economic development division, which works with local and regional organizations to promote business recruitment and retention in the City.

POLICY 10.1.1.1: ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT FUND.

Refine funding mechanism and establish an Economic Development Fund Policy, to advance the interests of retaining and recruiting businesses or targeted industries.

POLICY 10.1.1.2: ECONOMIC INCENTIVES.

Create and maintain guidelines for development and redevelopment incentives, which are flexible and can be modified as the economy dictates, to retain and recruit businesses and targeted industries.

POLICY 10.1.1.3: ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT MARKETING.

Publicize, promote, and market the City's assets, as well as the beneficial impacts of business investments within the City.

POLICY 10.1.1.4: BUSINESS RETENTION AND EXPANSION.

Promote retention and expansion of existing businesses.

GOAL 10.2: INCREASE ECONOMIC OPPORTUNITIES.

Cultivate Kissimmee's economy to provide more workforce opportunities for residents, sustainable services to the local market, and stable revenue sources for local businesses

OBJECTIVE 10.2.1: DIVERSIFY KISSIMMEE ECONOMY.

Target market sectors that are currently underrepresented in the Kissimmee economy.

POLICY 10.2.1.1: TARGET INDUSTRIES AND BUSINESSES.

Maintain and periodically revise a list of industries and businesses to be targeted for participation in the local business market.



POLICY 10.2.1.2: CAPITALIZE ON EXISTING ASSETS.

Capitalize on existing physical and community assets that have the potential to generate diversified economic development opportunities within the City.

OBJECTIVE 10.2.2: DEVELOP ACTIVITY CENTERS.

Pursue development of key activity centers within the City to accommodate economic growth and diversification.

POLICY 10.2.2.1: DOWNTOWN KISSIMMEE.

Revitalize and expand the economic, cultural and residential climate of Downtown Kissimmee.

POLICY 10.2.2.2: VINE STREET CORRIDOR.

Revitalize the Vine Street Corridor with higher density, mixed use, and transit-supportive development and redevelopment.

POLICY 10.2.2.3: KISSIMMEE GATEWAY AIRPORT.

Expand business and industrial development opportunities within, and around, the Kissimmee Gateway Airport.

POLICY 10.2.2.4: FOSTER AND FACILITATE NEW WORKFORCE CLUSTERS.

Continue networking opportunities to attract new corporate citizens into the City of Kissimmee and assist them during the transitional process.

GOAL 10.3: INFRASTRUCTURE IMPROVEMENTS.

Implement physical improvements and service enhancements necessary to support economic development within the City.

OBJECTIVE 10.3.1: TRANSPORTATION NETWORK.

Ensure the City's transportation network is sufficient to accommodate redevelopment and economic development activities.

POLICY 10.3.1.1: ENHANCEMENTS TO SUPPORT CURRENT AND FUTURE ACTIVITY CENTERS.

Provide multimodal transportation enhancements to support current and forthcoming land development and redevelopment projects within the City.

POLICY 10.3.1.2: COORDINATION WITH LOCAL AND REGIONAL TRANSPORTATION AND PLANNING ORGANIZATIONS.

Ensure the City's transportation infrastructure needs are included in MetroPlan, LYNX, FDOT and any other transportation organization's plans, work programs, and budgets.

POLICY 10.3.1.3: MULTIMODAL TRANSPORTATION AND FUNDING OPTIONS.

Continue support of network connectivity and accessibility, including the use of alternative modes of transportation to supplement automobile-based transportation, to ensure the efficient movement of employees and goods, as well as support efforts to create permanent funding sources for the respective modal systems.

OBJECTIVE 10.3.2: UTILITY NETWORK.

Ensure utility connections and supplies are sufficient to support redevelopment and economic development initiatives.

POLICY 10.3.2.1: COORDINATED UTILITY PLANNING.

Coordinate infrastructure planning with utility providers including the Toho Water Authority (TWA), Kissimmee Utility Authority (KUA), and any other future utility providers.

POLICY 10.3.2.2: UTILITY END USER.

Work with utility providers to facilitate the communication of the utility needs within business corridors, for current and future business entities.

OBJECTIVE 10.3.3: COORDINATE PLANNING AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT.

Coordinate planning and growth management initiatives with the City's economic development and redevelopment strategies.

POLICY 10.3.3.1: SIMPLIFY PERMITTING PROCEDURES.

Revise the City's regulatory processes to support economic development activities, particularly for identified and targeted market sectors.

POLICY 10.3.3.2: EXTERNAL ENTITY COORDINATION AND INVOLVEMENT.

Coordinate planning initiatives and regulatory processes with external partners and programs to ensure maximum dissemination of information for maximum economic benefit.

POLICY 10.3.3.3: HOUSING STOCK.

Diversify and improve the City's housing stock to provide sufficient residential opportunities for particular market sectors, including executive level housing, as the market dictates.



DATA, INVENTORY, AND ANALYSIS

INTRODUCTION

As noted in the 2016 Evaluation and Appraisal Report, the key overarching issue for the City of Kissimmee is economic development. This issue is attached to attracting and retaining diverse and quality employment opportunities, improving quality of life, and continued growth to be competitive in the Central Florida region and beyond. A major focus is on providing more jobs in general, and higher paying jobs in particular. Of particular interest are industries related to medical, technical, and aviation-related businesses.

For years, the City's economy has relied on tourism and associated services, with their preponderance of relatively low-wage jobs. However, the City also has robust employment in the public and medical sectors, with technology companies forming some of the most recent new additions to employment in and near the City.

EXISTING CONDITIONS

This section profiles the income and employment statistics for City residents and local businesses.

INCOME

The City of Kissimmee has deep ties to the leisure and hospitality industries, and has been associated with tourism for decades. This association has come to define the City's employment base, and its place within the greater Orlando-Kissimmee metropolitan statistical area (MSA). The City has not been able to keep pace with the income levels of local jurisdictions. Table 10-1 below shows the median income levels for various geographies and the table focus is on relevant information regarding City residents' relative income.

Table 10-1: Comparison of Area Median Incomes, 2008 and 2016

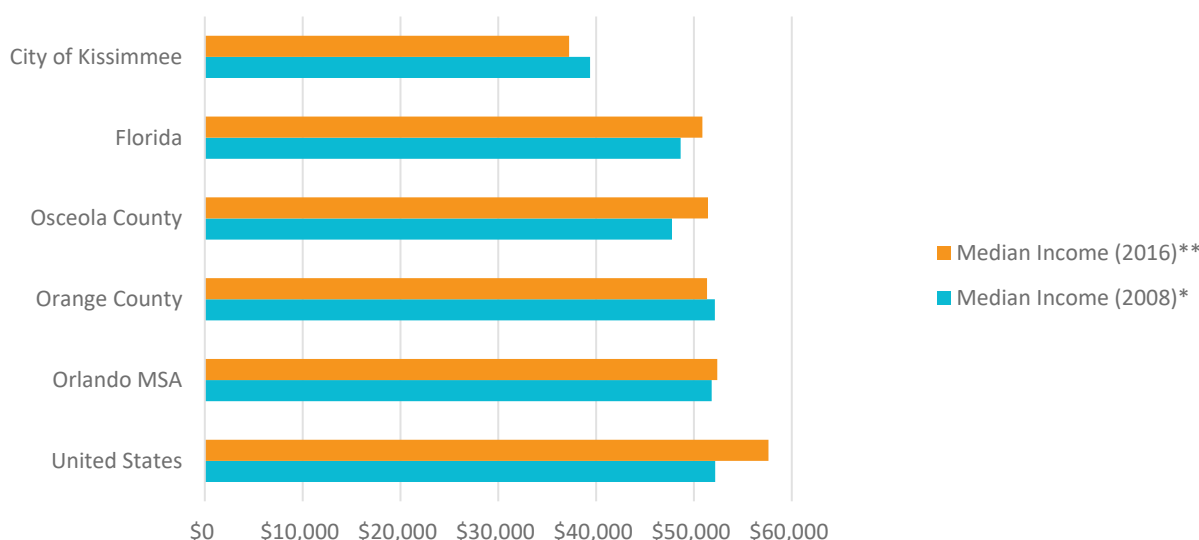
Geography	Median Income (2008)*	% of FL Median Income	Median Income (2016)**	% of FL Median Income
United States	\$52,175	107%	\$57,617	113%
Orlando MSA	\$51,813	107%	\$52,385	103%
Orange County	\$52,133	107%	\$51,335	101%
Osceola County	\$47,751	98%	\$51,436	101%
Florida	\$48,637	100%	\$50,860	100%
City of Kissimmee	\$39,382	81%	\$37,232	73%

Source: American Community Survey, 2008 and 2016.

*In 2008 dollars. **In 2016 inflation-adjusted dollars.

The data show that, between 2008 and 2016, the median incomes of each level of geography remained nearly the same, relative to the state's median income – except the United States as a whole and the City of Kissimmee. The United States was previously 107 percent of the state's median and gained an additional 6 percent. The City's median income, which was already at only 81 percent of the state's median, lost an additional eight percent by 2016. The median income for City residents is now 28 percent less than the median income earned in Osceola County, and 30 percent less than the median income earned in the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA. These incomes are shown graphically in Figure 10-1 below.

Figure 10-1: Comparison of Area Median Incomes, 2008 and 2016



Source: American Community Survey, 2008 and 2016.

*In 2008 dollars. **In 2016 inflation-adjusted dollars.

These differences in median income provide a point of reference for the remaining tables in this analysis, since data for the City is limited. The Orlando-Kissimmee MSA and Osceola County serve as proxies for the City in their economic conditions, and based on the data in Table 10-1, the City is likely to have lower wages, and may also have higher rates of unemployment than the MSA or the County. Table 10-2 shows the differences in hourly wages in both the MSA and the state from 2014 to 2017. The figures trend in the same direction over time (upward), but the median hourly wages for the state are higher in every case.

The hourly wage for entry-level positions in the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA has, however, remained stable as a percentage of the Florida median hourly wage for entry-level employees. This is in contrast to a slowly increasing percentage, though still lower than the state as a whole, for experienced employees. The change for entry-level wage earners has been an increase of 72 cents per hour over the four years shown in Table 10-2 below, but in 2017 the median hourly wage for these employees in the Orlando-



Kissimmee MSA was \$2.69 per hour above what is now the Federal minimum hourly wage and \$1.84 per hour above the 2017 minimum wage in Florida. Values for the City are not available, but it is not unreasonable to assume that the median hourly wage for employees in the City is lower than for the MSA.

Table 10-2: Comparison of Hourly Wages in Orlando-Kissimmee MSA and Florida, 2014-2017

Year	Hourly Wages								
	Median			Entry-Level			Experienced		
	FL	ORL MSA	% of FL	FL	ORL MSA	% of FL	FL	ORL MSA	% of FL
2017	\$16.15	\$15.46	95.7%	\$10.03	\$9.94	99.1%	\$27.52	\$26.84	97.5%
2016	\$15.77	\$15.10	95.8%	\$9.80	\$9.71	99.1%	\$26.88	\$26.22	97.5%
2015	\$15.29	\$14.68	96.0%	\$9.53	\$9.48	99.5%	\$26.15	\$25.16	96.2%
2014	\$14.94	\$14.27	95.5%	\$9.40	\$9.22	99.1%	\$25.48	\$24.40	95.8%

Source: Florida Department of Economic Opportunity, 2014 – 2017.

EMPLOYMENT

The City of Kissimmee and Osceola County were, in general, hit hard by the worldwide economic recession starting in late 2007 but have seen growth since the economy has grown stronger. Figures from the Florida Department of Economic Opportunity, released in January 2018 provide a fairly complete picture of employment in the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA. The table below indicates the rates of unemployment in Kissimmee, the MSA, related counties, Florida, and the United States as a whole, for December of 2015, 2016, and 2017.

Table 10-3: Comparison of Unemployment Rates for Counties in the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA

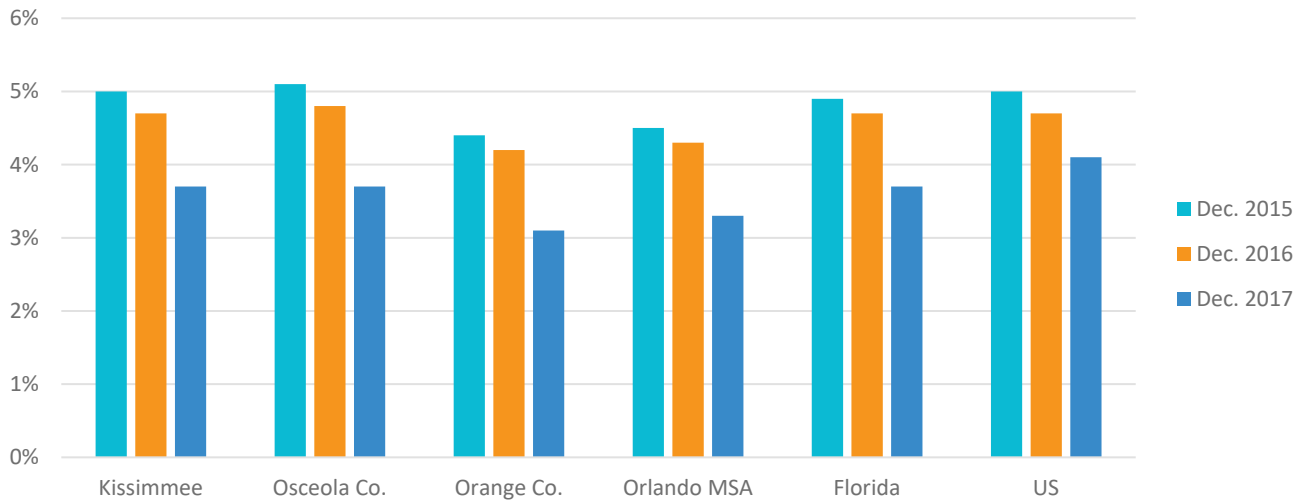
Time	Location					
	Kissimmee	Osceola Co.	Orange Co.	Orlando MSA	Florida	US
Dec. 2017	3.7%	3.7%	3.1%	3.3%	3.7%	4.1%
Dec. 2016	4.7%	4.8%	4.2%	4.3%	4.7%	4.7%
Dec. 2015	5.0%	5.1%	4.4%	4.5%	4.9%	5.0%
24 Month Change in Unemployment	-1.3%	-1.4%	-1.3%	-1.2%	-1.2%	-0.9%

Source: Florida Department of Economic Opportunity, January 19, 2018. Bureau of Labor Statistics.

In two years, unemployment in Kissimmee decreased by 1.3 percent from 5.0 percent to 3.7 percent. This decline in unemployment is not unique to Kissimmee although unemployment in the City still

remains higher than in the overall Orlando MSA but is on par with the State of Florida and below the United States as a whole. An illustration of these unemployment rates are shown in Figure 10-2 below.

Figure 10-2: Comparison of Unemployment Rates



Employment rates can be directly linked to the economic sectors most significantly (and historically) represented in the Orlando area. The close connection to the tourism industry, coupled with the construction, has a significant impact on the median hourly wage and the rate of unemployment. Table 10-4 below provides a snapshot of the employment in selected economic sectors from 2012 through 2016.

Table 10-4: Comparison of Employment, by Industry, in Orlando-Kissimmee MSA and Florida, 2010-2016

Year	Leisure and Hospitality		Construction		Educational and Health		Trade, Transportation, and Utilities		Professional and Business Services	
	ORL MSA	FL	ORL MSA	FL	ORL MSA	FL	ORL MSA	FL	ORL MSA	FL
2016	21.5%	14.3%	5.7%	5.8%	17.9%	21.0%	19.6%	21.2%	16.3%	15.5%
2015	21.5%	14.3%	5.4%	5.4%	18.0%	21.2%	19.8%	21.5%	16.0%	15.3%
2014	21.6%	14.2%	5.1%	5.2%	18.0%	21.4%	19.9%	21.5%	15.9%	15.1%
2013	21.2%	14.0%	4.9%	4.9%	18.2%	21.6%	19.9%	21.5%	16.0%	14.9%
2012	21.0%	13.8%	4.5%	4.7%	18.4%	21.9%	19.9%	21.5%	15.9%	14.7%
2011	20.9%	13.5%	4.6%	4.7%	18.4%	22.1%	19.9%	21.4%	15.6%	14.7%
2010	20.5%	13.2%	4.9%	4.9%	18.2%	22.0%	19.6%	21.2%	15.9%	14.8%

Source: Florida Department of Economic Opportunity, Annual NAICS Files 2010 - 2016.



The data shows that despite low unemployment rates and the lower wages typically found in this industry, the employment share in the Leisure and Hospitality industry continues to grow. This industry has held a steady share of the job market at 21.5 percent or higher since 2014, or over one fifth of total employment, despite an increase in the Construction industry which has historically been inversely related to the Leisure and Hospitality industry. While the Construction industry employment is similar to that found elsewhere in the State, the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA has a significantly higher reliance on the Leisure and Hospitality industry.

In contrast, the Educational and Health Trade, Transportation and Utilities, and Professional and Business Services industries maintained relatively steady employment percentages over time. The exception is a slight decrease in the Educational and Health industry from 18.2 percent in 2010 to 17.9 percent in 2016. In these industries the MSA has tended to maintain a lower percentage of employment than the state, except for Professional and Business Services, which is likely due to downtown Orlando's status as a location for business headquarters. The proportional differences between the MSA and Florida may be partially attributed to the higher percentage of MSA employment in the Leisure and Hospitality industry. A reduction in employment in the variable Leisure and Hospitality industry, and a corresponding increase in the more stable Educational and Health, Trade, Transportation and Utilities, and Professional and Business Services industries, could provide the MSA (and more specifically the City of Kissimmee) with the potential to improve its employment diversity and economic base.

In addition to numerous small, home-grown businesses, and mid-size regional and national chains, the City is home to several large, private employers, among which all three are within the Educational and Health industry. These enterprises, as seen in the table below, are on the rise in the Orlando-Kissimmee MSA and Florida, as a whole. These fields are important, both as aging baby-boomers and retirees begin to require more services, and as new generations seek to acquire the skills needed to be successful in their chosen fields.

Table 10-5: Large Employers within the City of Kissimmee

Employer	Number of Employees
Osceola Regional Medical Center	1,357
Valencia Community College	506
Florida Hospital - Kissimmee	450

Source: Greater Osceola Partnership for Economic Prosperity, 2015.

Other significant employers include Publix grocery stores, of which there are four in the City, and Wal-Mart retail stores near the City, of which there are two super centers and one neighborhood market. Growth by the medical service providers in the City have the potential to raise the economic prosperity of local employees, and the City's economic prospects for the future, but further diversification and

investment in modern industries and businesses are needed to raise the City's potential for economic success.

ECONOMIC POTENTIAL

In many cases, investment by outside entities first requires local investment. The City has been proactively engaged in improving economic conditions citywide for several years, with specific emphasis in several key locations. Among these are the downtown Community Redevelopment Area, the Kissimmee Gateway Airport area, and along the Vine Street corridor. This section details targeted efforts within the City.

REVITALIZATION EFFORTS

The City's downtown has existed for 135 years, and in that time has continuously experienced waves of growth, expansion, and redevelopment activity. In 1992, the City established the Community Redevelopment Agency (CRA) and crafted a CRA Plan for the City's downtown area in order to address the deteriorating physical and economic condition of the downtown area. CRA planning efforts aim to promote infill redevelopment on vacant parcels, which are guided by a set of design criteria adopted in 2008 and amended in 2012, and to provide support to local businesses.

The Vine Street corridor has long been a major thoroughfare leading tourists to both the City's downtown, but also to destinations beyond. The corridor has suffered from a history of automobile-oriented development, and the recent economic decline, and is currently a principal focus of redevelopment efforts within the City.

Envisioned as a transit-supportive corridor, with mixed-land uses, Vine Street will be among the centers for new commercial office and retail development and redevelopment, as well as residential uses.

The City has tailored land uses and design criteria in the downtown and along the Vine Street corridor to support development and redevelopment activity. These initiatives acknowledge the need to create destinations for residents and visitors that will help promote and initiate economic diversity in the City. Such an initiative could increase local employment, which could in turn reduce the number of commuters bound for Orlando.

While coordinating land uses and design with redevelopment, and maintaining coordination between the CRA and economic development agencies, is important, educational opportunities are also a key factor in the location and relocation of businesses. The investment in human capital can significantly help in business and new industry recruitment, as is the creation and support of business incubators – like the University of Central Florida-sponsored small business incubator in Kissimmee which includes 20 clients of various specialties. Businesses can use the resources of the incubator to further grow and upon



'graduating' establish themselves within the community with the ability to buy or sign a long term lease and continue growing their company as well as the number of employees.

INDUSTRY DIVERSIFICATION

Service industry businesses provide necessary and discretionary services such as medical care, child care, and increased retail and dining options to residents who rely on a demand base from the technical professions. The service industry is already established in the City, and accompanying technical industries are in their infancy and growing. This direct relationship between base industries and supportive industries has the power to lead to further economic development and employment opportunities for residents with different skill sets. The City has two major employment sectors being used to attract new technical and high-tech businesses. These two types of employment are aviation and related industries, and medical and ancillary medical industries.



MEDICAL AND HEALTHCARE

The Osceola Regional Medical Center is located within the City's Community Redevelopment Area (CRA). Coordination of business development initiatives with the goals established by the CRA is essential. The CRA is guided by a Plan and contains a special Tax Increment Financing (TIF) district. The revenues received from the TIF districts have been used to stimulate redevelopment by improving the public infrastructure, reducing development impediments, and providing various financial incentives for business start-up and expansion, in addition to other available incentives, discussed in-depth in the next section.

Another hospital, Florida Hospital Kissimmee, is located along Main Street/Orange Blossom Trail, north of both the CRA and the Vine Street redevelopment area. Though not eligible for bonuses associated with location in either of those two areas, other incentive opportunities are available through the creation of the Medical Arts District. The location of this District is shown on Future Land Use Element Figure 1-3. The City has established a policy for businesses growing and locating here, and evaluation or monitoring of the program in the future may help determine if adjustments are needed.

The goal of this District is to attract a hub of health-care related companies and physician practices between Florida Hospital Kissimmee and Osceola Regional Medical Center. Designated in April 2016 and offered for three years, new economic incentives created as part of this include:

- Reduction of development review fees

- Building permit fee reimbursement
- Medical equipment grant
- TV commercials
- Hire local grant

TRANSPORTATION

In addition to healthcare and general high-tech industries, the Kissimmee Gateway Airport, as a general aviation facility and reliever to the Orlando International Airport, has the potential to anchor aviation-related businesses proximal to the airport. In the last five years the City's economic development efforts have included attracting aviation academic companies to grow the local workforce skillset. The airport now has tenants with certification programs in the fields of Flight training, Avionics, and Airframe & Powerplant (A&P). It's rare to find all three of these programs at one airport. In addition to growing an aviation workforce, the City has launched an Aerospace Advancement Initiative at Kissimmee Gateway Airport. Similar to the Kissimmee Medical Arts District, this initiative offers eligible aerospace companies economic development incentives to help them offset some of their costs in establishing their company here. Those new incentives include:

- Building Life Safety-American Disabilities Act Upgrade Rebate
- Building Permit Fee Reimbursement
- Chamber of Commerce one year membership
- Development Review Fee Reimbursement
- Equipment Grant
- Hire Local Grant
- TV commercial



Proximity of major roadway corridors, the airport, and the future station on the southern expansion of the SunRail corridor could provide strategic opportunities for the encouragement of regionally significant businesses and industries. Retention and attraction of additional governmental services, in addition to County offices, could also spur the growth of government-serving businesses. The growth and development of aviation, medical and healthcare, and high-tech businesses presents opportunities for



the City to capitalize on business expansion and startup, which is critical to economic development and providing a broader job base.

RESOURCE PROTECTION

Another way to broaden the City's economy involves highlighting the City's location and natural amenities through historical tourism and ecotourism. This includes exploring opportunities to showcase the City's wealth of water-based natural resources, and historic sites and character. The water features and resources in the City already provide prime locations to engage in recreational activities.

Understanding that economic development and protection of important waterways are not mutually exclusive, the City of Kissimmee can support both initiatives by promoting ecotourism and continuing to take advantage of public-private partnerships, grant funding, second party acquisitions, and County land acquisition programs. The *Open Space and Recreation* map displays the locations of multi-use trails, parks, and open space areas that could be leveraged to encourage environmental visitors to the City.

Another potential economic growth area is that of historically-oriented tourism. Visitors are drawn to an area's history, and the City has a long and colorful one which it should continue to promote via the historic locations within the City.

FLORIDA HIGH TECH CORRIDOR

A regional initiative, involving 23 counties, is the promotion of north-central Florida (from St. Augustine and the Space Coast southwest to Tampa Bay) as a High Technology Corridor. Promoted with savvy marketing and engaging the collaboration of local and regional economic development organizations and universities, the initiative is working to encourage the location of certain types of businesses and industry sectors to the region. These sectors include:

- Agritechnology
- Aviation and Aerospace
- Digital Media/Interactive Entertainment
- Financial Services
- Information Technology
- Life Sciences/Medical Technologies

A regional initiative, involving 23 counties, is the promotion of north-central Florida (from St. Augustine and the Space Coast southwest to Tampa Bay) as a High Technology Corridor.

- Microelectronics/Nanotechnology
- Modeling, Simulation and Training
- Optics and Photonics
- Sustainable Energy

Coordination with the partner organizations of this initiative could provide the City with connections to grow local business diversity in these high-tech, and higher wage-earning, employment sectors.

ECONOMIC INCENTIVES

In order to attract outside investment, local governments must often provide incentives to interested parties. These attractions usually take the form of tax breaks and other monetary savings. The section below describes some incentives available to potential businesses.

FEDERAL AND STATE

One tool the City has leveraged is the availability of federal funds for redevelopment efforts. The City has previously applied for EPA Brownfield Assessment Grants in order to fund the assessment of approximately 20 potentially contaminated sites. Once the contamination level is determined, cleanup efforts can be pursued. The City hopes to utilize this federal program to spur redevelopment of sites that are currently underutilized due to the environmental stigma associated with particular properties. One success within Kissimmee through this program is the Lake Toho Redevelopment. This 10-acre urban renewal project is a transit-oriented development which will allow for the reuse of two brownfield sites that previously functioned as a power generation plant and a railroad spur and industrial site.



The State of Florida also offers incentives in the form of tax refunds and exemptions. The Qualified Target Industry (QTI) Tax Refund provides \$3,000 for each new job created in targeted high value-added industries. To qualify as a QTI, a business must create 10 or more jobs, pay more than 115 percent of area wages, have local support and have a significant positive impact on the community. The target industries are defined by the state, and include only those businesses serving multi-state and/or international markets. Retail activities, and activities regulated by the Division of Hotels and Restaurants or the Department of Business and Professional Regulation are statutorily excluded from consideration. The major industries and services include:



- Aviation & Aerospace
- Life Sciences
- Manufacturing
- Defense & Homeland Security
- Information Technology
- Financial & Professional Services
- Logistics & Distribution
- Cleantech
- Headquarters

The state also maintains a grant program, the Economic Development Transportation Fund, which provides up to \$3 million to local governments for the construction or improvement of transportation infrastructure needed to accommodate new or expanding industries.

The Florida Job Growth Grant Fund is a relatively new economic development program designed to build on Florida's success and economic prosperity since 2010. In its first year, the Florida Job Growth Grant Fund will provide \$85 million for public infrastructure and job training projects that support growth and employment in Florida's diverse industries. Public infrastructure projects can include transportation and utilities needed to support economic development. Workforce training projects will provide Floridians with transferable, sustainable workforce skills applicable to many employers.

COUNTY AND CITY

The County maintains a number of programs available countywide that are designed to assist businesses with relocation or expansion plans.

The City of Kissimmee also has its own criteria for targeted industry development and eligibility. Similar to State guidelines, a company must create at least 10 net new full time permanent jobs, or if expanding a business, increase employment by at least 10% and pay an average annual wage that is 115% higher than the local county average wage. State and/or County certified QTI projects will be eligible for the same incentives offered to City Targeted Industry. Companies must be in one of the City's target industry categories or be the company's corporate headquarters.

These companies include:

- Aeronautical (Aviation/Aerospace)
- Clean-Technologies, Alternative Energies or Renewable Resource Development
- Manufacturing
- Medical Specialties/Life Sciences
- Preparatory High School
- Post-Secondary Educational Institutions

The City and Osceola County have also instituted a five-day, fast-track permitting program, which is extended to eligible Economic Development projects. This ensures that new and existing companies and corporate relocations can occur without delay. In addition, the City of Kissimmee has a completely electronic permitting system which helps permits to be reviewed faster and reduces costs for the City and its customers.

SUMMARY

There are substantial challenges ahead regarding economic development. In a down economic market businesses tend not to expand, often contracting to the detriment of not just employees, but the community they serve. Strengthening partnerships with local and regional economic development organizations, such as the Osceola County Economic Development Commission and the Metro Orlando Economic Development Council, as well as local educational institutions are essential to attract targeted industries and to support and nurture existing local businesses.

The City's adopted goals, objectives, and policies of the Economic Development Element will provide the framework necessary to support economic investment programs and opportunities needed to provide the City with an increased commercial tax base and higher wage employment opportunities.

